

The Wichita Eagle 13A

Friday Morning, September 26, 1958

notified. Another pain was failure to get a first baseman, to replace Bella. That caused a bush practice of having to play a catcher on first, and he wasn't even passably good, at least here.

But let's look at the record as Al Smith used to say. Denver last year won the Junior World Series, highest honor in minor baseball. This year Denver, despite a badly crippled team, wound up in the playoffs and ACTUALLY WENT FURTHER THAN WICHITA DID. Denver at least got into the final set of games, it had SEVEN playoff games, not three as Wichita had.

So, what's so bad about that? While Denver did not win a pennant either year, it certainly has had strong, contending teams, under the Yankees. It never was lower than fourth, in four years. But Kansas City also soured on the Yanks, you'll recall.

Now, how about Wichita's Braves?

"Wichita did not have an interesting team. It was too much pitching, no player with much color. I believe that was the chief thing wrong this past season, after all, our club was not in contention at any time and wasn't even sure of the playoff until the last two days," Tom Kornhaus, prominent local sports follower, and a former coach, commented, after the Shocker Club meeting. "We just didn't play good ball when it counted," he added.

Which is true enough. Every time the Braves came back from a trip, they looked quite supine. "I wish we could look this way at home" moaned Ben Geraghty, at Omaha, after his Braves had pounced the ball hard, to win.

But too often they didn't, although of the last nine games here, at least three were as good as anyone would want to see. But would Denver have been any happier with the 1958 Wichita team, that with its own?

We're inclined to doubt it.

As for Andy Cohen's departure, it is to be regretted, as Andy was a right swell fellow, and always affable to newsmen. But it brings up quite a laugh. For early in August, Andy was nominated, right here in Wichita, as MANAGER OF THE YEAR.

All of which caused Ben Geraghty a few painful thoughts. "That will look rather strange if Denver doesn't even make the playoffs," commented Mr. Ben.

Well, Denver did rally enough to get in, but it flopped in the second series, after, however, beating Charleston.

The fortunes of baseball surely do go up, and down, almost as fast as the one in the Empire State Bldg.

Boots and Bingles

Visitor to the sports dept. Thursday was Roan Campbell, a former Eagle colleague, of 20 years back, who has since been a Washington, D.C., resident. Mr. Campbell is quite caustic about it, he is sure baseball in the nation's capital depends on getting rid of the present ownership. "Some fans even want the club taken to Minneapolis, they figure we would soon have another one, which would be worth watching," he avers. It might be a National League club, who knows? "The Griffiths never were very good baseball men. Sure, old Clark Griffith won a pennant or two when he was lucky enough to dig up Walter Johnson for the price of a scout's railroad ticket to Idaho. But those days are gone forever. The present owners don't even have any luck, to say nothing of baseball ability, or funds to get the men it takes to beat the Yankees," the former Kansan worded it.